Supporting documents for renaming Lieser Campus and Fir Grove/Vista

Lieser Campus, currently located on Lieser Road, will move to a remodeled Marshall Elementary in summer 2021. Lieser serves students in kindergarten through 12th grade in a variety of programs including Vancouver Home Connection, Virtual Learning Academy and Open Doors.

Fir Grove/Vista will move into its new school on Norris Road and 18th Street when construction is completed in January 2021. Fir Grove/Vista serves students with social emotional disabilities in kindergarten through 12th grade.

A committee of VPS staff members including the principals of the schools followed school board policy and procedures for renaming existing schools. Principals surveyed their students, staff members and their school community for name suggestions. The larger community also was asked to suggest names. Several names were proposed for both schools. Those that did not meet district policy and procedures were eliminated.

The following names were selected by committee members to move forward to the superintendent for final selection by the board of directors.

Lieser Campus

Bridge Creek Campus
Rationale: Bridge Creek was a bridge that crossed a creek at Fourth Plain Boulevard. The creek is now known as Burnt Bridge Creek. The word bridge describes the connection of the different learning programs located on one campus.

Broadmoor Campus
Rationale: An area of temporary housing used for shipyard workers during World War II. The area was south of MacArthur, between Blanford and Devine in the area now known as the Heights.

Heights Academy
Rationale: This name ties the school to its neighborhood location. It honors the area and can be an inspirational message to reach new heights. A new mascot could be mountaineers in honor of the surrounding beauty.

John Lewis School
Rationale: Representative John Lewis was a leader in the civil rights movement and congressman for more than 30 years. I feel that honoring his legacy would be an appropriate inspiring message to current and future students.

Fir Grove/Vista

Horizon School
Rationale: Horizon is forward thinking as in to broaden your horizons. Horizon ties to Vista, the name for the high school program at the school. Synonyms include prospect, perspective and outlook. These words describe the growth and promise the school provides to its students.

Dr. Jim Tangeman School: *Supporting testimonials follow*
Rationale: Dr. Jim Tangeman was a longtime respected Vancouver Public Schools administrator. He was a tireless advocate of students with special needs and their families. Dr. Tangeman opened Fir Grove Children's Center to fill a gap of services for students with mental health disabilities. Dr. Tangeman also led the work to open an alternative school so students who struggled in the traditional high school setting could . Long after his retirement, he continued to advocate for marginalized youth.

Victory Academy
Rationale: The new Fir Grove is located in an area known as Harney Heights, a neighborhood originally built to house families who moved to the area to build ships during World War II. Families grew victory gardens as a community effort during the rationed years of the war. The name invokes the historic area and community goodwill of the people.

Testimonials about Dr. Jim Tangeman

Dr. Steve Zimmerman, *VPS Psychologist, retired*
"Dr. Jim Tangeman dedicated his career to improving the lives and education of students who experienced less than their fair share of opportunity. Whether as administrator of special education services or the Juvenile Detention facility, principal of Pan Terra or Fir Grove Children's Center, or the many other formal and informal roles he played in our school district, Dr. Tangeman was a critical role model and mentor to students and a highly respected leader among his colleagues.

Fir Grove Children's Center would never have come to fruition were it not for the skilled leadership, refined expertise and unending passion of Dr. Jim Tangeman. While others in Vancouver and surrounding school districts laid the foundation for financial resources and the infrastructure of Fir Grove, Dr. Tangeman was the impetus in the development and implementation of the program, and ultimately transformed it into a highly functional learning environment for students with the greatest of needs. His talents and efforts provided the leadership to make it happen.

In August of 1991, given three weeks of preparation time, Dr. Tangeman led his teaching and support staff to become a highly functional and dedicated team, develop a comprehensive curriculum, refine a behavioral management system and create a welcoming environment for students and parents. On the very first day of school that fall 38 of the highest need students in grades K-8 came together for the start of a great adventure.

While there was rarely a day at Fir Grove without major challenges, Dr. Tangeman could always be relied upon to provide a calm and patient demeanor, skillfully using his engaging sense of humor to focus

planful solutions to highly complex problems. Countless students received enhanced educational opportunity and personal growth as a consequence of his dedication.

Even in retirement, Dr. Tangeman continued to contribute his talents to the Vancouver School District and community. He used his enduring energy to help facilitate the design, development and implementation of the Fruit Valley School/Community project. In addition, his ongoing work as a mental health counselor and educational consultant provided enduring benefit to our community.

Jim Tangeman was an inspiration to all who worked with him and is held in heartfelt admiration by the many recipients of his committed efforts. He is highly worthy of heroic recognition for the significant contributions he made to the honored history of Vancouver Public Schools and our community."

Tina Henry, *VPS Special Education Teacher, retired*
"If I were to select a person who gave many years to VSD and most especially to Fir Grove, it would be Dr. Jim Tangeman. He was a special education administrator, principled the Fir Grove program, and tirelessly solicited support for its students after his retirement.

Dr. T. See his resume. Ask his Lion's Club brothers and sisters. And talk with the staff with whom he worked with for so many years. He literally "served" the families in the Vancouver School District!"

Todd Horenstein, *VPS Associate Superintendent, retired*
"My interactions with Jim were always very positive. He was always very kid focused and just a great person from what I observed."

Doug Spencer, *VPS Associate Superintendent/CFO, retired*
"When I think of Jim, I always connect him with his support of special children. What comes to mind is a story of a young student, who always seemed to be in the principal's office to see Jim. For whatever reason the boy just could not focus on class work and stay out of trouble. One day Jim asked the boy if he noticed the flag at the school. This seemed to spark quite a bit of interest by the boy. So, Jim discussed the importance of the flag being raised before the buses arrived in the morning and lowered after the buses were gone after school. Jim showed the boy how the process worked in putting the flag out and taking it in. The boy was very proud of his new responsibility and recognition. He became known as Flag Boy at school and was never again sent to the office to see Jim. This is only one example of Jim's dedication to individual students. In my 46-year career with VPS, I cannot think of anyone more deserving than Dr. Jim Tangeman to have Fir Grove renamed after."

Jeanne Mack, *VPS Administrator, retired*
"Jim Tangeman invested every bit of himself into his students and continually adjusted to meet their needs. He believed in the nudge theory … the idea that sometimes the best solution is a series of small steps in a young person's life. The kind of steps that help a student gradually pick up momentum and suddenly realize one day they have made it."

Daniel Bettis, Executive Director, VPS Special Services
"Dr. Tangeman was a person of principle and humor. His guiding principle was focused on supporting students who experienced personal trauma. Dr. Tangeman was instrumental in creating a learning

environment that allowed individual students the opportunity to express their personal gifts while healing their wounded spirits. His work path took many bends over the years, but his guiding light was always centered on supporting those students who were often forgotten. Dr. Tangeman—or Dr. 'T'—would find the time to ensure each student had the chance at personal success. Dr. 'T' was a guiding light for many students."